

TRB Annual Meeting Poster Session Guidelines

Poster sessions are a valuable opportunity for authors to present papers and meet with interested attendees for in-depth technical discussions. TRB poster sessions are very well attended and a popular feature of the Annual Meeting. Good planning can make your presentation clear, effective and rewarding.

The goals in designing a poster should be:

- To attract attention,
- To provide a clear overview of your work,
- To provide enough material to explain the research without an oral explanation, and
- To provide enough material to initiate discussion and questions without overwhelming the audience.

What TRB Provides

Poster sessions are scheduled for 1 hour and 45 minutes in a large hall at the Convention Center. Several poster sessions will be taking place at once, with hundreds of papers being presented in each session time slot.

TRB provides a display board that is 4 feet high and 8 feet wide (122 cm high and 244 cm wide). In front of the display board, TRB provides a narrow table surface that is 6' long and 10" wide (183 cm long and 25 cm wide) and may be used to hold materials or a laptop computer.

TRB provides thumbtacks that presenters can use to attach posters made of paper or lightweight poster board. Each poster display board is numbered for easy identification by both authors and attendees. Please do *not* remove the numbers, as they will be used for other presentations throughout the meeting.

No electrical outlets will be provided. Please come with your computer charged!

What Authors Should Bring

- A single-sheet poster made of heavyweight poster paper or similar material, approximately 4 feet high and 8 feet wide (122 cm high and 244 cm wide).
- Heavy duty fasteners or tacks as back up to the thumbtacks.
- Authors may bring additional written material of a non-commercial nature that supplements the material presented on the poster.
- Business cards. This is a GREAT networking opportunity.
- Comfortable shoes. One hour and 45 minutes on your feet can be tiring!

Poster Session Rules

- Computers *without audio* may be used to run demonstrations and display additional information or illustrations. Telephone connections and other equipment are not allowed.
- Commercial advertising of products or services is not permitted.
- Although low-bandwidth Wi-Fi Internet will be available at the convention center, presenters should not rely on it for their presentations.
- There are no provisions for making posters at the meeting, nor for receiving, storing or returning posters to authors.
- Poster display boards must not be written on or defaced.
- Presenters are responsible for the removal of their poster after their session.

Poster Design Guidelines

- *Prepare poster on a SINGLE sheet* of heavy duty paper or similarly flexible material. The poster should be about 4 feet high and 8 feet wide. *Do not tack individual pages of a PowerPoint presentation or a text manuscript onto a poster board.*
- *Keep content SIMPLE.* A poster is a visual communication tool, not a manuscript. The viewer should be able to easily identify the primary concepts of the project without wading through a lot of text or complex formulas. Identify 3 or 4 main points or concepts to communicate.
- *Present text in bullets or small sections, broken up by subheadings.* Use at least 28–36 point bold sans serif font (e.g., Arial or Helvetica) for headers and 18–24 point font for text.
- *Present information in columns.* Arrange material in a logical sequence, from left top to bottom right.

- *Offer a balanced mix of text and graphics.* Too many words will result in people glossing over or simply bypassing your poster. A good rule of thumb is 50% text, 50% graphics and photos.
- *Avoid acronyms and jargon.* Simple language is best.
- *Avoid dark-colored backgrounds.* Use light colored backgrounds with black or very dark colored text. Graphics should similarly provide a stark contrast to be readable.
- *Use simple graphics.* Charts, drawings and illustrations should be limited to a 2-3 color palette at a resolution of at least 300 dots per inch. Visuals should be large enough to be comfortably read from 3 feet away.
- *Provide author name(s), organization(s), and/or other acknowledgements* to give credit to those who have done the work.
- *Prepare a brief (up to 5 minutes) oral presentation* for delivering to small audiences gathered around the poster.